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Registered number: 00061564

THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

ANNUAL REPORT AND FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

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THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

COMPANY INFORMATION

Directors	Steven Harlan Rosen Helmy Atef Eltoukhy
Company secretary	Deborah Andrew
Company registration number	00061564
Registered office	Bramall Lane Ground Cherry Street Sheffield South Yorkshire S2 4SU
Independent auditor	Grant Thornton UK LLP Chartered Accountants & Statutory Auditor Level 8 110 Queen Street Glasgow G1 3BX
Bankers	Santander UK Plc 58/60 Briggate Leeds West Yorkshire LS1 6AS

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THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

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STATEMENT FROM THE CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

As we reflect on the 2023/24 season, Sheffield United has undoubtedly faced its share of challenges, but we also have much to be proud of as a Club. Securing our return to the Premier League at the conclusion of last season was a momentous achievement, and while we encountered hurdles throughout the season, we continue to view this period as a critical step in our ongoing journey toward long-term success.

Our focus during the summer was to strengthen the squad, adding key players such as Vinicius Souza and Gustavo Hamer, and our commitment to building a competitive team was clear. Although we faced difficulties in terms of results, including key departures, our squad showed tremendous fight and resilience. The return of Chris Wilder sparked a positive momentum that we will carry forward into the future. While relegation was ultimately confirmed, our team's commitment, determination, and growth throughout the season have laid a strong foundation to secure a promotion to the top tier next season.

The Sheffield United Academy continues to be a key pillar of our long-term strategy. This season, we celebrated the under 21's remarkable achievement in winning both the England Professional Development League; North and National titles. We take immense pride in the development of our young talent, with players like William Osula and Oliver Arblaster stepping up to the first team and making their mark. Our priority is to ensure our academy remains a leader in developing top-tier talent while strategically managing our assets to maximise long-term value. By making calculated decisions—whether through player development, transfers, or loans—we position the club for sustained success, strengthening both our competitive edge and financial stability. This balanced approach ensures we continue building a legacy of excellence on and off the field. Our investments in facilities, combined with our commitment to achieving Category 1 Academy status, are vital steps in continuing to develop world-class talent for the future.

As a Club, we remain highly focused on ensuring we are not only performing on the pitch but also achieving long-term growth off it. We've seen strong performances across our revenue streams, from ticketing and commercial partnerships to merchandising. Support continued to be strong throughout the season demonstrating the continued loyalty of our fans with an average stadium attendance of 29,971. We have expanded our brand presence globally through our commercial partnerships, including a landmark deal with CFI in the MENA region. In merchandising, we are seeing impressive growth, particularly from international markets, and we are investing heavily in improving our online platform to maximise our global reach.

At Sheffield United, we understand that modern, high-quality facilities are essential to supporting both player development and fan experience. We have made significant investments this season, from upgrading training facilities to refurbishing key areas of Bramall Lane. The purchase of additional land for fan development is an important step in creating the best possible matchday experience. The ongoing refurbishment of our hotel and plans for a state-of-the-art new training facility are part of our vision to create long-term, sustainable revenue streams while also enhancing the overall experience for players and supporters alike.

While relegation to the Championship was a setback, we remain focused on the future. Our commitment to long-term growth, through player development, facility improvements, and strategic partnerships, is stronger than ever. We are optimistic about our future prospects, both on and off the pitch. We will continue to leverage our Academy to develop world-class talent, enhance our commercial success through international partnerships, and deliver a premium fan experience at every level. Sheffield United is on an exciting path, and I have no doubt that the best is yet to come.

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STATEMENT FROM THE CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER (CONTINUED)
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

I want to take a moment to sincerely thank our supporters, sponsors, directors, management, staff, players, and everyone involved in our community foundation. Your hard work, dedication, and passion for the Club mean everything. It's because of this shared commitment that we continue to grow, succeed, and build a legacy we can all be proud of.



Sincerely,
Stephen Bettis
Chief Executive Officer
Sheffield United Football Club
21/1/2025

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STRATEGIC REPORT
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

The directors are pleased to present the annual report for The Sheffield United Football Club Limited for the financial year ending 30 June 2024, which includes the financial statements and the Auditor's Report.

Principal activities

The principal activity of The Sheffield United Football Club Limited is the operation of a professional football club.

Business review

On-field performance

Men's First Team

Sheffield United experienced the excitement of securing promotion to the Premier League in the summer of 2023, but this achievement was swiftly met with the recognition of the significant challenges that lie ahead for newly promoted teams competing in the top tier of English football.

During the summer transfer window, the Club strengthened its squad with seven permanent signings: Auston Trusty from Arsenal, Gustavo Hamer from Coventry City, Vinicius Souza from Lommel, Tom Davies, Anis Ben Slimane from Brondby, Bénie Traoré from BK Häcken, and Cameron Archer from Aston Villa. In addition, loan signings included Yasser Larouci from ES Troyes AC, Luke Thomas from Leicester City, and James McAtee, who returned to the Club on loan from Manchester City. Key departures included Iliman Ndiaye, who transferred to Marseille, and Sander Berge, who joined Burnley, both transfers occurring due to the nearing expiry of their contracts, and the players' lack of desire to extend them further.

Despite strong performances in matches, including notable fixtures against Manchester City and Tottenham Hotspur, the Club struggled to secure points, earning just one point from a home match against Everton before securing the first win of the season against Wolverhampton Wanderers at Bramall Lane in November. A heavy 5-0 defeat away to Burnley in early December led to the departure of Manager Paul Heckingbottom and the reappointment of Chris Wilder as the Club's Manager.

In the January transfer window, the Club made further efforts to reinforce the squad by securing the loan signings of Ben Brereton Díaz from Villarreal and Mason Holgate from Everton, along with the permanent signing of Ivo Grbic from Atletico Madrid. Although there was an improvement in performances during the second half of the season, the Club remained in the relegation zone, and relegation to the EFL Championship was confirmed, on the 27th April following a defeat to Newcastle.

While the first team faced significant challenges, the Academy experienced notable success. Several of the Academy players made important developments, with William Osula, Rhys Norrington-Davies, Andre Brooks, and Oliver Arblaster establishing themselves as first-team regulars, while Ryan Oné and Sydie Peck made their senior debuts.

Player Development Pathway

The Sheffield United Academy plays a pivotal role in the Club's mission of "success with sustainability," aiming to generate revenue through player sales or reduce costs by developing players capable of integrating into the first team. The core objective of the Academy is to maximise player potential through a robust development program, with a guiding philosophy to Out Run, Out Fight, Out Play the opposition.

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Player Development Pathway (continued)

The Sheffield United Academy achieved significant success during the 2023/24 season, under the leadership of Academy Manager Derek Geary and the Academy Management Team. The under 21's team secured the England Professional Development League; North title for the fourth consecutive year, also being crowned National champions. The under 18's advanced to the 5th round of the FA Youth Cup, where they were narrowly defeated by eventual finalists Leeds United, marking the second consecutive year the team was eliminated by a finalist. Additionally, the under 21's reached the quarterfinals of the Premier League Cup, becoming the only Category 2 team to progress to this stage.

The loan market has become an increasingly important tool for player development and commercial recovery. Notable loan spells in the first half of the season included Oliver Arblaster at League One's Port Vale and Louie Marsh at Doncaster, with Marsh's tenure cut short due to injury. Miguel Freckleton enjoyed a successful season with Chesterfield, winning the National League title and contributing to their impressive FA Cup run, including a standout performance against Championship side Watford.

A strong transfer, recruitment, and development strategy has been integral to the Academy's success. Key signings during the summer transfer window included Ryan Oné from Hamilton and Jevan Beattie from Motherwell. Several Academy graduates established themselves as regulars in the first team during the 2023/24 season, including William Osula, Rhys Norrington-Davies, Andre Brooks, and Oliver Arblaster. In addition, Ryan Oné and Sydie Peck made their senior debuts, with Jordan Amissah, Evan Easton, Dovydas Sasnauskas, Louie Marsh, Sai Sachdev, Jili Buyabu, Owen Hampson, and Billy Blacker also featuring in matchday squads, highlighting the importance of the Academy's development pathway to the first team's success. Academy graduate Iliman Ndiaye was transferred to Marseille in the Summer 2023 window, providing a significant return on investment for the Club.

Internationally, the Club saw several Academy players represent their respective countries: Oliver Arblaster in the England under 20's squad, Ryan Oné in the Scotland under 19's squad, Levis Pitan in the Poland under 20's squad, and Dovydas Sasnauskas in the Lithuania under 19's squad. Sai Sachdev was also called up to the England under 19's squad.

Off the pitch, Sheffield United has made significant investments in its Academy facilities, reinforcing the Club's commitment to developing homegrown talent. At the end of the season, Michael Collins, under 21's Coach, was promoted to the first-team coaching staff, and under 18's Coach Matthew Thorpe moved on to a role with the England national team. These changes led to the internal promotion of Gary McSheffrey to the under 21's position and Jim O'Brien to the under 18's role, demonstrating the Club's commitment to continuous improvement and talent development across its operations.

Despite relegation, the Club remains dedicated to supporting the Academy. The long-term goal is to achieve Category 1 Academy status, and throughout the 2024/2025 season, the Academy will position itself to transition smoothly to this next level while continuing to develop players capable of progressing to the first team or generating revenue through player sales.

Off-field performance

Revenue Generation

Ticketing

Ahead of securing a return to the Premier League, the Club undertook a benchmarking exercise on season ticket pricing. It was determined that an increase was necessary for the forthcoming season to address rising operational costs, particularly in relation to facility management. A £1 per match increase was implemented for renewals, with 22,228 general admission supporters committing to a season-long membership, resulting in a record level of season ticket income, supporting the Club's ability to absorb rising costs such as utilities.

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Ticketing (continued)

Matchday attendances remained strong, with an average of 29,971 spectators per match during the season *(2023: 28,763)*, ranking the Club 13th in the Premier League for match attendance. A record crowd of 31,543 was achieved in the season, marking the highest attendance at Bramall Lane since the 2019/20 season against Brighton. Season ticket attendance increased by 3% year-on-year, and match-by-match attendance rose by 20%.

The Club remains dedicated to improving the fan experience, with a particular focus on enhancing access control systems. In preparation for the 2024/25 season, work has been underway to implement near-field communication (NFC) ticketing which will reduced costs, eliminate the need for physical tickets and season cards, and ultimately provide an enhanced experience for fans. This initiative is expected to position Bramall Lane as a premier event space, maximising its potential as a significant revenue stream.

Commercial

The Club's commercial operation, encompassing sponsorship, advertising, partnerships, and hospitality, saw both notable achievements and challenges during this period. Sheffield United made significant strides in expanding commercial partnerships, enhancing matchday experiences, and broadening its global brand presence. The sponsorship portfolio flourished, with the Club securing a seven-figure principal partnership with CFI, further strengthening its brand in the MENA region, and a sleeve partnership with the UK-based technology company G-Tech. Additionally, 75% of expired agreements were successfully renewed, particularly in sectors such as technology, manufacturing, leisure, and retail. These partnerships have not only bolstered revenue streams but have also enhanced the Club's positioning as an innovative and attractive partner for the upcoming season.

The competition for sponsorships in the Premier League proved to be challenging, particularly due to the Club's stance on betting, gaming, and alcohol-related partnerships. Nonetheless, the Club's adaptability and commitment to cultivating long-term relationships have kept it on track for sustained commercial growth. Looking ahead, the Club remains confident in its strategy to strengthen Sheffield United's commercial footprint both domestically and internationally.

Merchandising

Sheffield United's official kit partnership with Errea continued into the 2023/24 season. During the year, replica shirt sales increased by 6,000 units from the previous season, despite challenges in the market stemming from the growing prevalence of counterfeit merchandise. To protect the Club's intellectual property, the Club engaged professionals who successfully removed 1,697 counterfeit listings. However, given the rise in counterfeit activity, the Club may need to develop a more comprehensive strategy for enforcement and education going forward.

While merchandising revenues saw a slight decline following the closure of the Meadowhall store, a decision made due to its cost inefficiency, performance indicators remain strong. Conversion rates in the Bramall Lane store improved compared to the previous year, and the average basket size remained constant. International merchandising sales saw a 36% increase, with 32% of these sales originating from the USA, demonstrating the potential for further growth in this market. This aligns with the Club's long-term goal to develop SUFC Direct as the primary platform for merchandise sales, focusing on improving website usability and fulfilment processes. We view this as the most significant opportunity for growth in this revenue stream.

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Facilities and Property

Bramall Lane

The Club remains committed to enhancing the facilities at Bramall Lane to ensure the safety, comfort, and enjoyment of its loyal supporters. Significant investments were made during the 2023/24 season to refurbish all Executive Boxes, the Boardroom, and the Directors' Box. Additionally, at the close of the season, work commenced on the refurbishment of the Platinum Suite, which will be rebranded for the 2024/25 season.

A long-term refurbishment plan for the general admission areas also began, with key infrastructure works taking place, including upgrades to energy supply, fire protection systems, and kitchen refurbishments. These works are expected to continue into the 2024/25 season. Furthermore, the Club purchased two pieces of land adjacent to Bramall Lane, Cutlers Corner and Boundary Corner, in April 2024. The Club plans to develop the Boundary Corner site into a dedicated FanZone before the start of the new season.

Shirecliffe

Following the installation of a Desso pitch at the Shirecliffe site in 2023, ongoing work continued to improve the quality of playing surfaces. The all-weather pitch was resurfaced, and new floodlights were installed. Additionally, significant refurbishments took place in back-office and rehabilitation areas, including the installation of a dedicated bath and ice room, as well as upgrades to gym and treatment rooms. Dining and nutrition areas were also refurbished to support elite performance and player well-being.

The Club has expressed a desire to expand its Academy operations, as the current pitch space at Shirecliffe is a limiting factor to the operation. While the Club continues to operate efficiently within the constraints of the site, plans are underway to improve its functionality and capacity.

Dore Training Facility

After three years of negotiations, the Club acquired the HSBC Sports and Social Club site in Dore, Sheffield, with a deposit paid in April and the balance satisfied in August 2024. This acquisition offers the opportunity to develop a state-of-the-art training facility that will meet the demands of a competitive Premier League team. Early-stage planning is underway, and once operational, this facility will allow the Academy to take over the Shirecliffe site, which will then be developed to meet the Category 1 Elite Player Performance Plan criteria, enabling the Club to attract and retain top talent at the Academy level.

Business Centre

The Blades Business Hub, located at Bramall Lane, continues to grow and now houses over 20 small businesses, including The Sheffield United Community Foundation Ltd, a related party to the group. The Community Foundation delivers education and employability programmes in partnership with Barnsley College, the University of South Wales, and DWP from its Youth Hub, within the Business Centre. The Hub's state-of-the-art E-Sports facilities, including an Esports suite, F1 Simulator suite, podcast room, and student breakout room, provides an unparalleled learning experience.

The Youth Hub, which helps over 200 young people a year into employment, is the only one of its kind located within a professional football stadium in the UK and is the best performing Youth Hub in South Yorkshire for 2024.

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Facilities and Property (continued)

Derek Dooley Community Sports Centre

The Club made the difficult decision to close the Derek Dooley Community Sports Centre in 2020 due to changes in the gym market that rendered the operation unsustainable. However, over the 2023/24 season, the senior leadership team, in collaboration with consultants and planners, explored potential uses for the site. These consultations have been positive, and the Club is hopeful to re-open the site in 2025, providing much-needed sports facilities to the local community.

Engagement with Stakeholders

The values of integrity, hard work, ambition, and inclusivity are central to the culture at Sheffield United and play a pivotal role in driving the Club's long-term goal of achieving success and sustainability, both on and off the pitch. The Board of Directors acknowledges the critical importance of engaging effectively with stakeholders to meet these objectives. In line with their obligations under Section 172 of the Companies Act, which requires directors to act fairly in the interests of all stakeholders and the wider community, the Club actively considers the perspectives of stakeholders in both short-term and long-term planning.

To strengthen stakeholder engagement, the Club has undertaken a number of initiatives during the year. These include the establishment of the Fan Advisory Board, the relaunch of the staff wellbeing committee, the continuation of the equality, diversity, and inclusion group, and the expansion of employee support packages.

The creation of the Fan Advisory Board (FAB) has established a direct communication channel between the fans, the Chief Executive Officer and the Senior Leadership Team. This initiative ensures that fans remain integral to the Club's plans. Comprising eight representative supporters, the FAB meets regularly to offer advice and provide feedback to the Chief Executive Officer, and the senior leadership team. The board's role is crucial in shaping the fan experience while ensuring that the traditions and heritage of Sheffield United are preserved.

Sheffield United understands that its people are its greatest asset. The Club continuously reviews its people policies to identify opportunities for improvement across all areas. It strives to create an environment where every staff member feels valued and is recognised for their contributions. The Club believes strongly in staff development and internal progression. Learning and development now play a key role in the annual appraisal process, with numerous examples of the Club supporting professional growth. To assess employee satisfaction, an anonymous employee engagement survey is conducted annually, which provides valuable insights that inform planning for the year ahead.

The Club is also committed to fostering a safe and welcoming environment for all staff and visitors. A dedicated team of professionals in areas such as Equality, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI), Safeguarding, and Health and Safety, among others, works to ensure a positive experience for everyone involved with the Club. The commitment to diversity and inclusion was recognised at the Football Supporters Association Awards, where Sheffield United won the Fans for Diversity Award. Additionally, the Club earned the EFL Family Excellence Gold Award, further highlighting its efforts in creating an inclusive environment.

The United Wellbeing initiative, led by the Club's Head of HR, promotes the emotional, social, psychological, and physical health of all employees. The Wellbeing Committee, which includes representatives from across the business, meets regularly to assess and improve the support provided to employees. This group is responsible for developing a program of events that enhances the overall employee experience, both in their professional and personal lives. Recent enhancements to employee benefits, such as the inclusion of life coverage for all permanent staff members, further exemplify the Club's ongoing commitment to the well-being of its employees. Additionally, we provide a range of initiatives to support our people, including enhanced healthcare services with online GP access, mental health first aiders, and various well-being resources.

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Engagement with Stakeholders (continued)

We are committed to equality and fairness in opportunities, pay, and promotions, and we publish our Gender Pay Gap report annually. The club is dedicated to fostering equality and diversity, ensuring that no employee faces discrimination based on age, disability, ethnicity, nationality, religion, race, gender, or any other factor. A dedicated Equality, Diversity and Inclusion committee meets regularly to review the Club's policy and practices to promote continuous improvement across all areas of the operation, in line with the Club's values of Inclusivity. An external EDI panel is also in place, which consists of elected individuals representing key areas of focus for the EDI group, to help guide policy and to provide a voice to the Club on matters of importance so that these can be addressed.

The Club holds Disability Confident status, meaning we are an employer that is committed to hiring and developing people with disabilities. Applications for employment from disabled individuals are always given full consideration, taking into account the applicant's abilities and potential. If a staff member develops a disability or condition that impacts their ability to perform their job, every effort is made to support their continued employment within the company, with appropriate training provided. The company is committed to ensuring that the training, career development, and promotion of disabled employees are, as far as possible, on par with those of other staff members.

The Board also recognises the importance of selecting suppliers and customers who align with the Club's values. Rigorous checks are conducted at the onboarding stage of all supplier and customer relationships to ensure that their policies and practices are consistent with Sheffield United's values. The Club continues to review its supply chain to ensure that no partners are engaged whose practices contradict the Club's ethical standards. To protect the interests of all stakeholders, the Board ensures that payment practices are clearly communicated to customers in the Club's terms and conditions and that these practices are regularly monitored.

Charitable Activities

The Club's nominated charities for the season were:

- Sheffield Children's Hospital
- Weston Park Cancer Charity
- St Luke's Hospice
- Bluebell Wood Children's Hospice
- Sheffield Hospitals Charity

The Sheffield United Community Foundation Ltd, a related party to the group, leverages the power of the Club's brand to engage with local communities and deliver a broad range of initiatives. These initiatives focus on improving health and wellbeing, raising aspirations, and building stronger, more cohesive communities. Further details of the Foundation's activities can be found in its annual report.

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Future Developments

Sheffield United's long-term goal is to establish itself as a sustainable, successful club, both on and off the pitch. Achieving this will require a strategic business model that prioritises investment in the playing squad, the development of elite academy players, global brand expansion, and the diversification of revenue streams. Additionally, the Club will continue to identify and nurture talent across all areas of the business.

In recent years, the Club has made significant investments in the development of its stadium, transforming it into a venue that is not only a suitable Premier League home ground but also a commercially attractive event space. As part of its ongoing development, the Club will focus on enhancing Bramall Lane's role as a key destination in Sheffield. Over the course of the 2024/25 season, the Club plans to build on this progress by utilising the recently acquired Boundary Corner site to create a dedicated FanZone area, further enhancing the matchday experience. Additionally, the redevelopment of the hotel at Bramall Lane will be completed, making the stadium an even more attractive venue for both football fans and other events. These developments will strengthen the Club's position to secure future concerts and competitive sports fixtures, adding valuable new revenue streams.

Beyond commercial planning, the Club recognises the need to continue expanding and improving its sporting facilities. The much-anticipated acquisition of a new training site in Dore in the summer of 2024 marks the beginning of an exciting new chapter for the Club. While significant work is required to make the site suitable for hosting the First Team, this acquisition presents a unique opportunity. Over the next twelve months, the Club will engage with planners and developers to design a state-of-the-art training facility that meets the standards expected of an elite professional football team. Once completed, the First Team will relocate to Dore, which will free up space at the current Shirecliffe site. This will allow the Club to expand its development programme, aiming to secure a Category One Elite Player Performance Plan License and enhancing its player development pathway.

These developments represent a clear, strategic vision for the Club's future, positioning Sheffield United for continued success both on and off the pitch.

At the start of the 2024/2025 season, the Club will begin its Championship campaign with a 2-point deduction, following sanctions imposed by the EFL as a result of a disciplinary commission's decision on 28 March 2024. Despite this challenge, the Club is confident that our first team recruitment and development strategy will result in competitive performance in the 2024-25 season, and remains dedicated to a return to the Premier League.

Financial Performance Overview

The Club has reported a net profit of £2.4 million for the period, a significant recovery from a loss of £31.5 million in 2023. This profit is stated after an impairment of tangible fixed assets of £10.7 million, following the revaluation of property assets to reflect their revised market value and a provision of £14.8 million against intercompany receivables due from the parent company.

Revenue

The Club achieved revenue of £137.6 million, representing an increase of £73.7 million from £63.9 million in 2023. This growth was primarily driven by a substantial rise in broadcast revenues, which reached £114.3 million *(2023: £42.7 million)* following promotion to the Premier League. Non-broadcast revenues also demonstrated robust growth, increasing to £23.3 million *(2023: £21.2 million)*, reflecting the ongoing expansion and refurbishment of commercial inventory, alongside the Club's commitment to enhancing Bramall Lane as a premier hospitality venue.

Despite a challenging commercial environment in the summer of 2023, where several clubs began the season without shirt sponsors due to increased competition for marketing spend, the Club secured a successful principal partnership for the 2023/24 season with Dubai-based financial services provider, CFI Financial Group. This partnership provides a significant global marketing opportunity, leveraging the international platform afforded by the Premier League.

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Financial Performance Overview (continued)

Cost of Sales

Cost of sales increased to £77.5 million *(2023: £57.8 million)*, primarily reflecting higher player wages and other direct costs associated with the Club's promotion to the Premier League including increased investment in technology to assist in player recruitment and performance management, in addition to general cost of living increases such as increased utility costs and minimum wage increases.

Administrative Expenses

Administrative expenses (as split on the face of profit or loss) rose to £37.0 million *(2023: £20.3 million)*, due to a £2.4m increase in charitable donations made by the Premier League on the Clubs behalf, and the impairment of certain intercompany loan balances of £14.8 million which have been provided for given the uncertainty of recovery of a balance due from Blades Leisure Limited (see impairment of investments below).

Interest Expenses and Income

Interest payable amounted to £9.6 million *(2023: £3.8 million)*, driven by the discounting of future cashflows payable related to player trading, which totalled £3.5 million *(2023: £Nil)*. Conversely, interest receivable increased to £1.6 million *(2023: £Nil)*, entirely attributable to the discounting of future cashflows receivable related to player trading.

Impairment of Investments and Tangible Fixed Assets

Following a review of intercompany balances, a provision was made for the uncertain recovery of a balance due from Blades Leisure Limited.

A revaluation of the Club's property assets has been undertaken to ensure that they are stated at fair value. Changes to the to the base rate since the prior valuation in 2021 have significantly impacted the discount rate applied to the future cash flows from these assets, which is used to establish market value. This interest rate change, alongside the general challenges faced by valuers in establishing market value through the comparable sale of similar assets, in particular stadia, have significantly impacted the value calculation, resulting in an impairment to the held asset value of £20.7 million. An impairment charge of £10.7 million and the elimination of a revaluation reserve of £10.0 million have therefore been posted in the period. It should be noted however that the cost of reinstatement of these assets to the Club, established at the same valuation date, is £196 million.

Investments and Player Trading

During the period, the Club invested £52.6 million in player registrations *(2023: £4.6 million)*, including high-profile acquisitions such as Cameron Archer, Vinicius De Souza Costa, and Ivo Grbic. Player disposals generated a profit of £19.4 million *(2023: £4.4 million)*, with notable transfers including Iliman Ndiaye to Olympiacos-Marseille and Sander Berge to Burnley FC.

Additionally, the Club made substantial investments in tangible fixed assets, amounting to £12.2 million. Key initiatives included the redevelopment of the hotel adjacent to Bramall Lane to operate as a DoubleTree by Hilton, along with significant refurbishments to premium areas of the stadium. Three land acquisitions were made, consolidating the ownership of the Bramall Lane site through the acquisition of the Boundary Corner and Cutlers Corner sites and advancement of plans for a new first-team training facility through a commitment to purchase land in Dore, Sheffield, which completed after the year end date.

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Key Performance Indicators

Non-financial performance indicators

	2024 (Premier League)	*2023 (Championship)*
First team finishing position	**20**	*2*
Points per game	**0.42**	*1.97*
Average league attendance	**29,971**	*28,763*

Financial performance indicators

	2024 (Premier League)	*2023 (Championship)*
Employee costs as % of revenue	**46%**	*75%*
Commercial revenue growth % vs prior year	**125%**	*14%*
Profit on disposal of player registrations	**£19.4m**	*£4.4m*

Statement of Financial Position

As of June 2024, the Club reports a net asset position of £3.3 million *(2023: restated £10.9 million)*. While investments made during the period have enhanced the total asset base, debt levels have risen. Net current liabilities of £31.3 million *(2023: £7.2 million)* are expected to be met through player sales in the summer of 2024. Intangible assets are valued at historical cost less accumulated amortisation and any accumulated impairment losses, though the Directors believe the value of player registrations held is sufficient to cover any potential shortfall.

The year-end cash position of £0.4 million *(2023: £0.6 million)* underscores the critical importance of prudent cash management. As the Club continues to strengthen its squad and invest in Premier League-ready assets, maintaining lean operations and the implementation of appropriate contractual clauses remains essential in mitigating potential risks of relegation. Efficient management of short-term working capital and debt obligations will be a priority for the Board to ensure long-term viability.

Streamlined Energy and Carbon Report

The Sheffield United Football Club Limited are a 'large unquoted company' under the Streamlined Energy and Carbon Reporting regulations and must report annually on greenhouse gas emissions from Scope 1 and 2 Electricity, Gas and Transport.

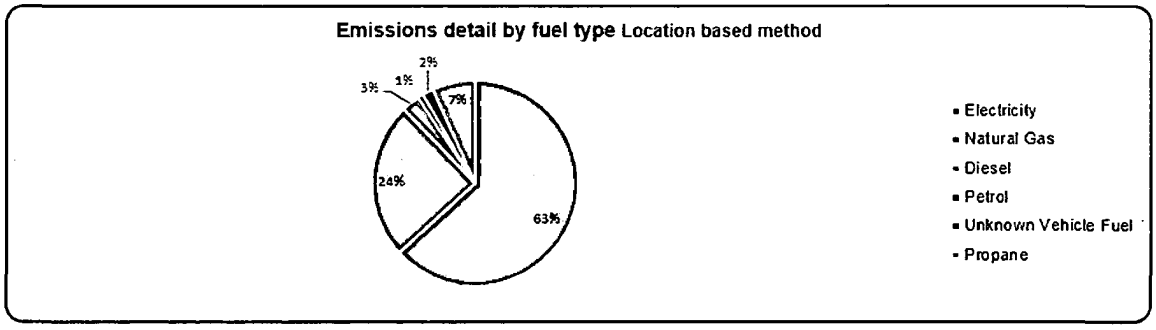
The reporting period is the most recent financial year 01/07/2023 to 30/06/2024. This report has been compiled in line with the March 2019 BEIS 'Environmental Reporting Guidelines: Including streamlined energy and carbon reporting guidance', and the EMA methodology for SECR Reporting. All measured emissions from activities which the organisation has financial control over are included as required under The Companies (Directors' Report) and Limited Liability Partnerships (Energy and Carbon Report) Regulations 2018, unless otherwise stated in the exclusions statement.

The carbon figures have been calculated using the DESNZ 2023 carbon conversion factors for all fuels, other than the market-based electricity which has been taken from EDF as the UK supplier.

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UK Carbon Footprint Data

Scope	Description	Emissions Source		tCO2e		
				2021/22	2022/23	2023/24
Scope 1	Combustion of fuel on site and transportation	On site: Natural Gas, Transport: Petrol, Diesel	Location Based	406	589	448
			Market Based	409	589	448
Scope 2	Purchased energy	Electricity	Location based	609	778	805
			Market based	0	0	0
Scope 3	Indirect Emissions	Employee Business Mileage	Location based	37	19	22
			Market based	37	19	22
Total			Location based	1,051	1,385	1,276
			Market based	443	608	470
Intensity Ratio	tCO2e/£1m Turnover		Location based	15.7	21.4	9.2
			Market based	6.6	9.4	3.4
Energy Usage	Total kWh consumed	Electricity, Natural Gas, Gas Oil, Petrol, Diesel, Unknown vehicle fuel		5,466,986	6,873,279	6,304,226
	Renewable %	Electricity				100%



Year on year emissions changes

The Sheffield United Football Club Limited's location based emissions decreased from 1385 tCO2e in 2022/23 to 1276 tCO2e in 2023/24, an emissions decrease of 7.9%. Against the base year of 2019/20, this is a emissions decrease of 6.4%.

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Year on year emissions changes (continued)

Scope 1 emissions decreased from 589 tCO2e in 2022/23 to 448 tCO2e in 2023/24, an emissions decrease of 23.9%. This is due to a reduction in natural gas consumption accompanied by a reduction in additional site gas (propane) usage. Natural gas consumption reduced from 2,143,919 kWh in 2022/23 to 1,721,000 kWh in 2023/24 resulting in an emissions decrease of 77 tCO2e. Propane emissions were also reduced by 41.8%, emissions dropped from 146 tCO2e to 85 tCO2e.

The emissions associated with scope 1 transport (petrol & diesel) slightly decreased from 51 tCO2e in 2022/23 to 47 tCO2e in 2023/24, a 9% reduction in emissions.

Scope 2 electricity consumption increased from 3,755,032 kWh in 2022/23 to 3,808,062 kWh in 2023/24, this is a 1.4% increase in consumption. Scope 2 location based emissions increased from 778 tCO2e to 805 tCO2e. Under the market based method, Sheffield United Football Club Ltd continue to report no tCO2e emissions associated with their purchased electricity.

The Sheffield United Football Club Ltd report their intensity ratio on a turnover basis. Emissions per £m turnover have decreased from 21.4 tCO2e/£m turnover in 2022/23 to 9.2 tCO2e/£m turnover in 2023/24.

Energy efficiency actions taken

- Upgrading Stadium and Academy site lighting to LED, alongside flood lighting replacements for the Academy site.
- Stadium Ventilation & ducting replacements made within the latest reporting period.
- All kitchens located within the stadium have been refurbished as well as academy laundry area.
- Sheffield United have joined the EFL Green Club initiative which will drive sustainability across all sites over the next 10 years.
- Instructed a feasibility study as to how to become carbon neutral.
- Currently in the design phase for the installation of PV across the stadium as well as battery storage and EV charging.
- As standard across refurbishment projects, replacing existing inefficient HVAC equipment.
- Currently phasing out gas boilers at the academy site and replacing with electric which will be powered by EV.

Going concern

The Club's business activities, together with factors likely to affect its future development, performance, and position, have been considered by the directors throughout the period and will continue to be reviewed in line with the Club's strategic plan.

The directors have reviewed the forecasts for the period ending January 2026, which demonstrate the Club can operate within its planned facilities including, if required, support from its controlling parties, for the period.

The directors therefore have a reasonable expectation that the Club will be able to continue in operational existence for the foreseeable future with support from its controlling parties. For this reason, they continue to adopt the going concern assumption.

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Principal Risks and Uncertainties

The company faces various financial risks, primarily related to liquidity, interest rates, sporting performance, and regulatory compliance, as detailed below.

- **Liquidity Risk**: The company manages liquidity by ensuring adequate facilities are in place with its bankers and other lenders.
- **Interest Rate Risk**: The company's operations are financed through a mix of shareholder equity, retained earnings and bank loans with a focus on managing interest rate exposure.
- **Sporting Performance Risk**: The company mitigates sporting risks through strategic investment in recruitment, retention, and development of players and support staff, incorporating contractual safeguards to protect financial stability.
- **Regulatory Compliance Risk**: As a member of various leagues and competitions, the company ensures strict adherence to regulations, with continuous monitoring of compliance and potential regulatory changes that could impact operations.

Section 172 statement

Section 172 (1) of the Companies Act sets out the matters that a director of a company must have regard to in fulfilling his or her duty to promote the success of the company for the benefits of its members, in doing so, give regard to:

i. Likely consequences of any decisions in the long term
ii. The interests of the company's employees
iii. The need to foster the company's business relationships with suppliers, customers and others
iv. The impact of the company's operation on the community and the environment
v. The desirability of the company maintaining a reputation for high standards of business conduct

The Board of directors consider that they have acted in good faith in these matters in a way in which promotes the success of the club for the benefit of its members as a whole. The Board of Directors and senior leadership team of the Club meet regularly on both a formal and informal basis to review and improve operations. All material decisions that have a potential long-term impact on the business are discussed at a meeting of the Board of Directors before approval is given to proceed. The impact of these decisions is considered in the context of the company's employees, suppliers, customers, the community, and the environment. The core values of the Club are integrity, hardworking, ambitious, and inclusive. Fostering these values throughout the business, acting in an open, honest, ethical, and fair way, ensures that high standards of business conduct and the Club's reputation are maintained and protects the heritage of Sheffield United Football Club for generations to come.

This report was approved by the board and signed on its behalf.



Steven Harlan Rosen
Director

Date: 21/1/2025

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DIRECTORS' REPORT
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

The directors present their report and the financial statements for the year ended 30 June 2024.

Results and dividends

The profit for the year, after taxation, amounted to £2,418,532 *(2023: restated loss £31,527,401).*

The directors did not recommend the payment of dividend in the year *(2023: £Nil).*

Directors

The directors who served during the year were:

HRH Princess Reem Bint Abdullah Al Saud (resigned 23 December 2024)
Joseph Edward Jr Giansiracusa (resigned 23 December 2024)
Abdullah Yousef Mohammed Alghamdi (resigned 23 December 2024)

Steven Harlan Rosen and Helmy Atef Eltoukhy were appointed as directors after the year ended on 23 December 2024.

Directors' Responsibilities Statement

The directors are responsible for preparing the Strategic Report, the Directors' Report and the financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations.

Company law requires the directors to prepare financial statements for each financial year. Under that law the directors have elected to prepare the financial statements in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (United Kingdom Accounting Standards and applicable law, including FRS 102 'The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland'). Under company law the directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs and profit or loss of the Club for that period. In preparing these financial statements, the directors are required to:

- select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;
- make judgements and accounting estimates that are reasonable and prudent;
- state whether applicable UK Accounting Standards have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements; and
- prepare the financial statements on the going concern basis unless it is inappropriate to presume that the Club will continue in business.

The directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the Club's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the Club and enable them to ensure that the financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They are also responsible for safeguarding the assets of the Club hence for taking reasonable steps for the prevention and detection of fraud and other irregularities.

The directors are responsible for the maintenance and integrity of the corporate and financial information included on the Club's website. Legislation in the United Kingdom governing the preparation and dissemination of financial statements may differ from legislation in other jurisdictions.

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DIRECTORS' REPORT (CONTINUED)
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Matters covered in the Strategic Report

- Engagement with employees, customers, suppliers and others
- Streamlined energy and carbon reporting
- Future developments
- Principal risks

Post balance sheet events

Details of post balance sheet events are given in note 31 of the financial statements.

Disclosure of information to auditor

The directors confirm that:

- so far as each director is aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the Club's auditor is unaware; and
- the directors have taken all the steps that they ought to have taken as directors in order to make themselves aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the Club's auditor is aware of that information.

Auditor

The auditor, Grant Thornton UK LLP, will be proposed for reappointment in accordance with section 485 of the Companies Act 2006.

This report was approved by the board and signed on its behalf.



Steven Harlan Rosen
Director

Date: 21/1/2025

Docusign Envelope ID: 7A2D6F5D-81F8-4F19-8DB8-5B93316FFD53



INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of The Sheffield United Football Club Limited (the 'company') for the year ended 30 June 2024, which comprise the Statement of Comprehensive Income, the Statement of Financial Position; the Statement of Changes in Equity and notes to the financial statements, including a summary of significant accounting policies. The financial reporting framework that has been applied in their preparation is applicable law and United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including Financial Reporting Standard 102 'The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland' (United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

In our opinion:

- the financial statements give a true and fair view of the state of the company's affairs as at 30 June 2024 and of its profit for the year then ended;
- the financial statements have been properly prepared in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice; and
- the financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) (ISAs (UK)) and applicable law. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the 'Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements' section of our report. We are independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, including the FRC's Ethical Standard, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

We are responsible for concluding on the appropriateness of the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting and, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our report to the related disclosures in the financial statements or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify the auditor's opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our report. However, future events or conditions may cause the company to cease to continue as a going concern.

In our evaluation of the directors' conclusions, we considered the inherent risks associated with the company's business model including effects arising from macro-economic uncertainties such as cost of living crisis, we assessed and challenged the reasonableness of estimates made by the directors and the related disclosures and analysed how those risks might affect the company's financial resources or ability to continue operations over the going concern period.

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In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Other information

The other information comprises the information included in the Annual Report, other than the financial statements and our Auditor's Report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information contained within the Annual Report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in our report, we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

Our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the audit or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, we are required to determine whether there is a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact.

We have nothing to report in this regard.

Opinions on other matters prescribed by the Companies Act 2006

In our opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of the audit:

- the information given in the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements; and
- the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report have been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

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INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED (CONTINUED)

Matter on which we are required to report under the Companies Act 2006

In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we have not identified material misstatements in the Strategic Report or the Directors' Report.

Matters on which we are required to report by exception

We have nothing to report in respect of the following matters in relation to which the Companies Act 2006 requires us to report to you if, in our opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- the financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of directors' remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit.

Responsibilities of directors

As explained more fully in the Directors' Responsibilities Statement set out on page 15, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, the directors are responsible for assessing the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

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Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an Auditor's Report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists.

Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Irregularities, including fraud, are instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. The extent to which our procedures are capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud, is detailed below:

- We enquired of management whether they were aware of any instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations or whether they had any knowledge of actual, suspected or alleged fraud. We corroborated our enquiries through direct confirmation with those charged with governance.
- We identified significant laws and regulations, as detailed below, relevant to the company through inquiries of management and corroborated this through review of board minutes and legal expenses.
- We obtained an understanding of the legal and regulatory frameworks that are applicable to the company and determined which may influence the financial statements. We determined that the most significant which are directly relevant to specific assertions in the financial statements are those related to the reporting frameworks (FRS 102 and Companies Act 2006), the relevant tax compliance regulations in the jurisdictions in which the company operates, the specific regulations for the industry including Premier League Rules and Regulations, English Football League Regulations and The FA Rules and Regulations. In addition, we concluded that there are certain significant laws and regulations that may have an effect on the determination of the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements and those are laws and regulations related to health and safety, employee matters, data protection, import duty, and bribery and corruption practices.
- We assessed the susceptibility of the company's financial statements to material misstatement, including how fraud might occur. We performed procedures over journal entries (in particular journal entries determined to be large or relating to unusual transactions), related party transactions and evaluated processes and controls in place to address the risks related to irregularities and fraud.
- In assessing the potential risks of material misstatement, we obtained an understanding of the company's operations, the applicable statutory provisions, and the company's control environment, including the adequacy of procedures for authorisation of transactions.
- These audit procedures were designed to provide reasonable assurance that the financial statements were free from fraud or error. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement due to fraud is higher than the risk of not detecting one resulting from error and detecting irregularities that result from fraud is inherently more difficult than detecting those that result from error, as fraud may involve collusion, deliberate concealment, forgery or intentional misrepresentations. Also, the further removed non-compliance with laws and regulations is from events and transactions reflected in the financial statements, the less likely we would become aware of it;

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- The engagement team's experience with similar engagements, their understanding of the company's industry and regulatory requirements (FRS 102, the Companies Act 2006, the relevant tax compliance regulations, Premier League Rules and Regulations, English Football League Regulations and The FA Rules and Regulations) relating to the company were considered in assessing the competence and capabilities of the engagement team.

A further description of our responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located on the Financial Reporting Council's website at: www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of our Auditor's Report.

Use of our report

This report is made solely to the company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an Auditor's Report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the company and the company's members as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.

James Chadwick

James Chadwick
Senior Statutory Auditor
for and on behalf of Grant Thornton UK LLP
Statutory Auditor, Chartered Accountants
Glasgow
Date: 21/1/2025

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STATEMENT OF COMPREHENSIVE INCOME
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Note	2024 £	*As restated 2023 £*
Turnover	4	**137,599,836**	*63,932,388*
Cost of sales		**(77,509,884)**	*(57,780,933)*
Gross profit		**60,089,952**	*6,151,455*
Administrative expenses (excluding amortisation and impairment of intangible assets)		**(37,018,643)**	*(20,296,984)*
Amortisation and impairment of intangible assets	12	**(20,375,960)**	*(18,135,763)*
Impairment of tangible assets	13	**(10,701,351)**	-
Total administrative expenses		**(68,095,954)**	*(38,432,747)*
Other operating income	5	**560,606**	*175,419*
Operating loss	6	**(7,445,396)**	*(32,105,873)*
Profit on disposal of intangible assets		**19,350,718**	*4,418,578*
Total operating profit/(loss)	6	**11,905,322**	*(27,687,295)*
Interest receivable and similar income	9	**1,550,224**	-
Interest payable and similar expenses	10	**(9,558,759)**	*(3,840,106)*
Profit/(loss) before tax		**3,896,787**	*(31,527,401)*
Tax on profit/(loss)	11	**(1,478,255)**	-
Profit/(loss) for the financial year		**2,418,532**	*(31,527,401)*
Loss on revaluation		**(10,024,536)**	-
Other comprehensive income for the year		**(10,024,536)**	-
Total comprehensive income for the year		**(7,606,004)**	*(31,527,401)*

The notes on pages 26 to 56 form part of these financial statements.

Please see note 30 for information on the restatement of prior year.

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THE SHEFFIELD UNITED FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED
REGISTERED NUMBER:00061564

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
AS AT 30 JUNE 2024

	Note		2024 £		As restated 2023 £
Fixed assets					
Intangible assets	12		**46,355,137**		*18,563,069*
Tangible assets	13		**42,564,227**		*54,125,320*
Investments	14		**2.**		-
			88,919,366		*72,688,389*
Non-current assets					
Debtors: amounts falling due after more than one year	16		**11,748,583**		-
Current assets					
Stocks	15	**442,514**		*414,789*	
Debtors: amounts falling due within one year	16	**13,699,927**		*29,284,173*	
Cash at bank and in hand	17	**376,906**		*630,061*	
		14,519,347		*30,329,023*	
Creditors: amounts falling due within one year	18	**(45,788,698)**		*(37,535,140)*	
Net current liabilities			**(31,269,351)**		*(7,206,117)*
Total assets less current liabilities			**69,398,598**		*65,482,272*
Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year	19		**(57,969,955)**		*(46,496,989)*
Deferred income	22		**(8,147,766)**		*(8,098,402)*
Net assets			**3,280,877**		*10,886,881*
Capital and reserves					
Called up share capital	24		**72,448,202**		*72,448,202*
Revaluation reserve	25		**-**		*10,024,536*
Profit and loss account	25		**(69,167,325)**		*(71,585,857)*
Equity attributable to owners of the parent company			**3,280,877**		*10,886,881*

Docusign Envelope ID: 7A2D6F5D-81F8-4F19-8DB8-5B93316FFD53

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION (CONTINUED)
AS AT 30 JUNE 2024

The financial statements were approved and authorised for issue by the board and were signed on its behalf by:



Steven Harlan Rosen
Director

Date: 21/1/2025

The notes on pages 26 to 56 form part of these financial statements.

Please see note 30 for information on the restatement of prior year.

Docusign Envelope ID: 7A2D6F5D-81F8-4F19-8DB8-5B93316FFD53

STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN EQUITY
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Share capital	Revaluation reserve	Retained earnings	Total equity
	£	£	£	£
At 1 July 2023 (as previously stated)	72,448,202	10,024,536	(73,470,798)	9,001,940
Prior year adjustment	-	-	1,884,941	1,884,941
At 1 July 2023 (as restated)	72,448,202	10,024,536	(71,585,857)	10,886,881
Comprehensive income for the year				
Profit for the year	-	-	2,418,532	2,418,532
Loss on revaluation	-	(10,024,536)	-	(10,024,536)
Total comprehensive income for the year	-	(10,024,536)	2,418,532	(7,606,004)
At 30 June 2024	72,448,202	-	(69,167,325)	3,280,877

STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN EQUITY
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2023

	Share capital	Revaluation reserve	Retained earnings	Total equity
	£	£	£	£
At 1 July 2022 (as previously stated)	43,643,702	10,024,536	(42,017,705)	11,650,533
Prior year adjustment	-	-	1,959,249	1,959,249
At 1 July 2022 (as restated)	43,643,702	10,024,536	(40,058,456)	13,609,782
Comprehensive income for the year				
Loss for the year (as restated)	-	-	(31,527,401)	(31,527,401)
Total comprehensive income for the year	-	-	(31,527,401)	(31,527,401)
Shares issued during the year	28,804,500	-	-	28,804,500
At 30 June 2023 (as restated)	72,448,202	10,024,536	(71,585,857)	10,886,881

The notes on pages 26 to 56 form part of these financial statements.

Docusign Envelope ID: 7A2D6F5D-81F8-4F19-8DB8-5B93316FFD53

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

1. General information

The Sheffield United Football Club Limited ("the Club") is a private company limited by shares, incorporated in England and Wales. Registered number 00061564. The Club's registered office is Bramall Lane Ground, Cherry Street, Sheffield, S2 4SU.

2. Accounting policies

2.1 Basis of preparation of financial statements

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention unless otherwise specified within these accounting policies and in accordance with Financial Reporting Standard 102, the Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and the Republic of Ireland and the Companies Act 2006.

The preparation of financial statements in compliance with FRS 102 requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires Club management to exercise judgement in applying the Club's accounting policies (see note 3).

The Club's presentational and functional currency is Sterling and all values are rounded to the nearest pound (£) except when otherwise stated.

The following principal accounting policies have been applied:

2.2 Financial Reporting Standard 102 - reduced disclosure exemptions

The Club has taken advantage of the following disclosure exemptions in preparing these financial statements, as permitted by the FRS 102 "The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland":

- the requirements of Section 7 Statement of Cash Flows;
- the requirements of Section 3 Financial Statement Presentation paragraph 3.17(d);
- the requirements of Section 33 Related Party Disclosures paragraph 33.7.

This information is included in the consolidated financial statements of Blades Leisure Limited as at 30 June 2024 and these financial statements may be obtained from Companies House.

2.3 Exemption from preparing consolidated financial statements

The company is a parent company that is also a subsidiary included in the consolidated financial statements of a larger group by a parent undertaking established under the law of any part of the United Kingdom and is therefore exempt from the requirement to prepare consolidated financial statements under section 400 of the Companies Act 2006.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.4 Going concern

The Club's business activities, together with factors likely to affect its future development, performance, and position, have been considered by the directors throughout the period and will continue to be reviewed in line with the Club's strategic plan.

The directors have reviewed the forecasts for the period ending January 2026, which demonstrate the Club can operate within its planned facilities including, if required, support from its controlling parties, for the period.

The directors therefore have a reasonable expectation that the Club will be able to continue in operational existence for the foreseeable future with support from its controlling parties. For this reason, they continue to adopt the going concern assumption.

2.5 Turnover

Turnover comprises revenue generated by the Club's principal activities excluding transfer fees, donations and value added tax. Revenue streams include the below:

Match day

Match day revenue consists of all income receivable in respect of match day fixtures held both at home and away. It is inclusive of ticket revenues for home fixtures and a share of gate receipts from cup fixtures held both at home and away from Bramall Lane. The share of gate receipts payable in respect of cup fixtures is deducted from revenue.

Match day revenue which is received in advance of a period end but relating to a future year (mainly in relation to seasonal facilities) is treated as deferred income. The deferred income is then released to revenue as the matches are played.

Broadcasting

Broadcasting revenues represent income receivable from all broadcasting and publishing contracts including the Premier League central deals, EFL distributions, broadcasting revenue from cup fixtures, internet revenues and programme income. Premier League and EFL distributions comprise of a fixed element, which is recognised equally over home fixtures played, along with additional revenues that are variable based on final league position.

Sponsorship & advertising

Sponsorship and advertising revenues include revenue receivable from sponsors in the year, including shirt sponsorship and other advertising at the ground. Such revenue is recognised on an accruals basis across the years the sponsorship and advertising income relates to.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.5 Turnover (continued)

Facility

Facility revenues include rental and facility hire income, academy and retail income. Facility revenue is recognised in the year in which the facility has been utilised. Where facility income is received or invoiced in a year it is treated as deferred income and released in the year to which the income relates.

The academy income is in the form of an elite player performance grant which contributes to the running costs of the academy.

2.6 Other operating income

Grants of a revenue nature are recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Income in the same period as the related expenditure.

2.7 Intangible assets

Intangible assets are initially measured at present value, discounted at a market rate of interest for a similar debt instrument. After recognition, intangible assets are then measured less any accumulated amortisation and any accumulated impairment losses.

All intangible assets are considered to have a finite useful life. If a reliable estimate of the useful life cannot be made, the useful life shall not exceed ten years.

The estimated useful lives range as follows:

Trademarks	-	10	years

Transfer fees paid for player registrations

The costs of acquiring player registrations, including Club agents fees, are expensed over the length of the contract, to reflect the ongoing service provided. The expectation of Club agent fees based on players future salaries in the league in which we are competing are also expensed over the length of the players contract.

Potential future registration fees, contingent on certain conditions agreed in the registration contracts with the selling company, are disclosed as contingent liabilities (see note 32).

Gains and losses on disposals are determined by comparing the proceeds with the carrying amount and are recognised in profit or loss.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.8 Tangible assets

Tangible assets under the cost model are stated at historical cost less accumulated depreciation and any accumulated impairment losses. Historical cost includes expenditure that is directly attributable to bringing the asset to the location and condition necessary for it to be capable of operating in the manner intended by management.

The Club adds to the carrying amount of an item of fixed assets the cost of replacing part of such an item when that cost is incurred, if the replacement part is expected to provide incremental future benefits to the Club. The carrying amount of the replaced part is derecognised. Repairs and maintenance are charged to profit or loss during the period in which they are incurred.

Depreciation is charged so as to allocate the cost of assets less their residual value over their estimated useful lives, using the straight-line method.

Depreciation is provided on the following basis:

Buildings	- 2% straight line basis
Fixtures and fittings	- 10%-25% straight line basis
Motor vehicles	- 25% straight line basis

The assets' residual values, useful lives and depreciation methods are reviewed, and adjusted prospectively if appropriate, or if there is an indication of a significant change since the last reporting date.

Gains and losses on disposals are determined by comparing the proceeds with the carrying amount and are recognised in profit or loss.

2.9 Revaluation of tangible assets

Individual freehold and leasehold properties are carried at current year value at fair value at the date of the revaluation less any subsequent accumulated depreciation and subsequent accumulated impairment losses. Revaluations are undertaken with sufficient regularity to ensure the carrying amount does not differ materially from that which would be determined using fair value at the reporting date.

Fair values are determined from market-based evidence normally undertaken by professionally qualified valuers.

Revaluation gains and losses are recognised in other comprehensive income unless losses exceed the previously recognised gains or reflect a clear consumption of economic benefits, in which case the excess losses are recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Income.

2.10 Operating leases

Rentals paid under operating leases are charged to the Statement of Comprehensive Income on a straight-line basis over the lease term.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.11 Impairment of fixed assets and goodwill

Assets that are subject to depreciation or amortisation are assessed at each reporting date to determine whether there is any indication that the assets are impaired. Where there is any indication that an asset may be impaired, the carrying value of the asset (or cash-generating unit to which the asset has been allocated) is tested for impairment. An impairment loss is recognised for the amount by which the asset's carrying amount exceeds its recoverable amount. The recoverable amount is the higher of an asset's (or CGU's) fair value less costs to sell and value in use. For the purposes of assessing impairment, assets are grouped at the lowest levels for which there are separately identifiable cash flows (CGUs). Non-financial assets that have been previously impaired are reviewed at each reporting date to assess whether there is any indication that the impairment losses recognised in prior periods may no longer exist or may have decreased.

2.12 Valuation of investments

Investments in subsidiaries are measured at cost less accumulated impairment. Where merger relief is applicable, the cost of the investment in a subsidiary undertaking is measured at the nominal value of the shares issued together with the fair value of any additional consideration paid.

2.13 Stocks

Stocks are stated at the lower of cost and net realisable value, being the estimated selling price less costs to complete and sell. Cost is based on the cost of purchase on a first in, first out basis.

At each reporting date, stocks are assessed for impairment. If stock is impaired, the carrying amount is reduced to its selling price less costs to complete and sell. The impairment loss is recognised immediately in the Statement of Comprehensive Income.

2.14 Debtors

Short-term debtors are measured at transaction price, less any impairment.

Loans receivable are measured initially at fair value, net of transaction costs, and are measured subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any impairment.

2.15 Cash and cash equivalents

Cash is represented by cash in hand and deposits with financial institutions repayable without penalty on notice of not more than 24 hours. Cash equivalents are highly liquid investments that mature in no more than three months from the date of acquisition and that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash with insignificant risk of change in value.

2.16 Financial instruments

The Club has elected to apply the provisions of Section 11 "Basic Financial Instruments" of FRS 102 to all of its financial instruments.

Financial instruments are recognised in the Club's Statement of Financial Position when the Club becomes party to the contractual provisions of the instrument.

Financial assets and liabilities are offset, with the net amounts presented in the financial statements, when there is a legally enforceable right to set off the recognised amounts and there is an intention to settle on a net basis or to realise the asset and settle the liability simultaneously.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.16 Financial instruments (continued)

Basic financial assets

Basic financial assets, which include trade and other receivables, cash and bank balances, are initially measured at their transaction price including transaction costs and are subsequently carried at their amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any provision for impairment, unless the arrangement constitutes a financing transaction, where the transaction is measured at the present value of the future receipts discounted at a market rate of interest.

Discounting is omitted where the effect of discounting is immaterial. The Club's cash and cash equivalents, trade and most other receivables due within the operating cycle fall into this category of financial instruments.

Other financial assets

Other financial assets, which includes investments in equity instruments which are not classified as subsidiaries, associates or joint ventures, are initially measured at fair value, which is normally the recognised transaction price. Such assets are subsequently measured at fair value with the changes in fair value being recognised in the profit or loss. Where other financial assets are not publicly traded, hence their fair value cannot be measured reliably, they are measured at cost less impairment.

Impairment of financial assets

Financial assets are assessed for indicators of impairment at each reporting date. Financial assets are impaired when events, subsequent to their initial recognition, indicate the estimated future cash flows derived from the financial asset(s) have been adversely impacted. The impairment loss will be the difference between the current carrying amount and the present value of the future cash flows at the asset(s) original effective interest rate.

If there is a favourable change in relation to the events surrounding the impairment loss then the impairment can be reviewed for possible reversal. The reversal will not cause the current carrying amount to exceed the original carrying amount had the impairment not been recognised. The impairment reversal is recognised in profit or loss.

Financial liabilities

Financial liabilities and equity instruments are classified according to the substance of the contractual arrangements entered into. An equity instrument is any contract that evidences a residual interest in the assets of the Club after the deduction of all its liabilities.

Basic financial liabilities, which include trade and other payables, bank loans and other loans are initially measured at their transaction price after transaction costs. When this constitutes a financing transaction, whereby the debt instrument is measured at the present value of the future payments discounted at a market rate of interest. Discounting is omitted where the effect of discounting is immaterial.

Debt instruments are subsequently carried at their amortised cost using the effective interest rate method.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.16 Financial instruments (continued)

Trade payables are obligations to pay for goods and services that have been acquired in the ordinary course of business from suppliers. Trade payables are classified as current liabilities if the payment is due within one year. If not, they represent non-current liabilities. Trade payables are initially recognised at their transaction price and subsequently are measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method. Discounting is omitted where the effect of discounting is immaterial.

Derecognition of financial assets

Financial assets are derecognised when their contractual right to future cash flow expire, or are settled, or when the Club transfers the asset and substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership to another party. If significant risks and rewards of ownership are retained after the transfer to another party, then the Club will continue to recognise the value of the portion of the risks and rewards retained.

Derecognition of financial liabilities

Financial liabilities are derecognised when the Club's contractual obligations expire or are discharged or cancelled.

2.17 Deferred Income

Deferred income represents the sales made for the following season in season tickets and sponsorship, as these go on sale prior to the end of the prior football season. These will all be released in the period to which they relate to revenue.

2.18 Interest Receivable and Interest Payable

Interest payable and similar charges include interest payable on loan and overdraft and notional interest expense on deferred payments for player registrations. Borrowing costs that are directly attributable to the acquisition, construction or production of an asset that takes a substantial time to be prepared for use, are capitalised as part of the cost of that asset.

Interest receivable and similar income include interest receivable on cash held at bank and notional interest on deferred receipts for sale of players' registrations.

Interest receivable and interest payable are recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Income as they accrue, using the effective interest method.

2.19 Creditors

Short-term creditors are measured at the transaction price. Other financial liabilities, including bank loans, are measured initially at fair value, net of transaction costs, and are measured subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

2.20 Finance costs

Finance costs are charged to the Statement of Comprehensive Income over the term of the debt using the effective interest method so that the amount charged is at a constant rate on the carrying amount. Issue costs are initially recognised as a reduction in the proceeds of the associated capital instrument.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.21 Pensions

Defined contribution pension plan

The Club operates a defined contribution plan for its employees. A defined contribution plan is a pension plan under which the Club pays fixed contributions into a separate entity. Once the contributions have been paid the Club has no further payment obligations.

The contributions are recognised as an expense in the Statement of Comprehensive Income when they fall due. Amounts not paid are shown in accruals as a liability in the Statement of Financial Position. The assets of the plan are held separately from the Club in independently administered funds.

Multi-employer pension plan

The Club is a member of a multi-employer plan. Where it is not possible for the Club to obtain sufficient information to enable it to account for the plan as a defined benefit plan, it accounts for the plan as a defined contribution plan.

Where the plan is in deficit and where the Club has agreed, with the plan, to participate in a deficit funding arrangement the Club recognises a liability for this obligation. The amount recognised is the net present value of the contributions payable under the agreement that relate to the deficit. This amount is expensed in the Statement of Comprehensive Income. The unwinding of the discount is recognised as a finance cost/(benefit).

2.22 Borrowing costs

All borrowing costs are recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Income in the year in which they are incurred.

2.23 Provisions for liabilities

Provisions are made where an event has taken place that gives the Club a legal or constructive obligation that probably requires settlement by a transfer of economic benefit, and a reliable estimate can be made of the amount of the obligation.

Provisions are charged as an expense to the Statement of Comprehensive Income in the year that the Club becomes aware of the obligation and are measured at the best estimate at the reporting date of the expenditure required to settle the obligation, taking into account relevant risks and uncertainties.

When payments are eventually made, they are charged to the provision carried in the Statement of Financial Position.

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2. Accounting policies (continued)

2.24 Current and deferred taxation

Tax is recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Income except that a charge attributable to an item of income and expense recognised as other comprehensive income or to an item recognised directly in equity is also recognised in other comprehensive income or directly in equity respectively.

The current income tax charge is calculated on the basis of tax rates and laws that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting date in the countries where the Club operates and generates income.

Deferred tax is calculated at the tax rates that are expected to apply to the period when the asset is realised or the liability is settled based on tax rates that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting date.

Deferred tax liabilities are recognised in respect of all timing differences that exist at the reporting date. Timing differences are differences between taxable profits and total comprehensive income that arise from the inclusion of income and expenses in tax assessments in different periods from their recognition in the financial statements. Deferred tax assets are recognised only to the extent that it is probable that they will be recovered by the reversal of deferred tax liabilities or other future taxable profits.

Current tax assets and current tax liabilities and deferred tax assets and deferred tax liabilities are offset, if and only if, there is a legally enforceable right to set off the amounts and the entity intends either to settle on the net basis or to realise the asset and settle the liability simultaneously.

2.25 Contingencies

Under certain transfer agreements further transfer payments may fall due to both the transfer Club and Player's Agents should the player make a specified number of first team appearances (or other such criteria as specified in the contract). It is the Club's policy that any additional fees that may become payable under such agreements are accounted for in the period in which the achievement of the specified criteria becomes probable.

Contingent assets are not recognised until the inflow of economic benefits are virtually certain. Contingent assets are disclosed in the financial statements when an inflow of economic benefits is highly probable.

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3. Judgements in applying accounting policies and key sources of estimation uncertainty

Estimates and judgements are continually evaluated and are based on historical experience and other factors, including expectations of future events that are believed to be reasonable under the circumstances. The directors made the following judgements and estimates in preparing the Financial Statements:

Critical judgements

The directors have not used any judgements (apart from those involving estimates) within the accounts to have any significant effect on amounts recognised in the financial statements.

Key sources of estimation uncertainty

The estimates and assumptions which have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amount of assets and liabilities are as follows.

3.1 Present value of player trading

The long-term player debtors and player creditors are measured at the present value of future receipts and payments discounted at a market rate of interest for a similar debt instrument.

3.2 Agent fee capitalisation

A portion of the Club's agent fees are capitalised against each player, the determination of this is based on the league in which we are currently competing over the term of their contract and the deemed cost of obtaining the players registration.

3.3 Present value of pension obligations

The funding objective of the Trustees of the Scheme is to have sufficient assets to meet the Technical Provisions of the Scheme. To remove the deficit revealed at the previous actuarial valuation (dated 31 August 2023), deficit contributions are payable by all participating clubs. Payments are made in accordance with a payment schedule. Determining the present value of the clubs share of the pension obligations requires significant assumptions determined by the schemes actuaries and therefore represents a key source of uncertainty, see note 26 for further detail.

3.4 Deferred tax asset

Following a review of the forecasts for future periods and the anticipated profit from the player trading in the transfer window, the company now expects to utilise a portion of available tax losses in future periods, and has recognised a deferred tax asset on a portion of tax losses carried forward at the balance sheet date. No deferred tax asset in respect of losses have been recognised in the prior year. See notes 11 and 23 for further detail.

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3. Judgements in applying accounting policies (continued)

3.5 Impairment of player registration

The valuation of intangible assets is given consideration by the directors. Under certain circumstances, the directors may commence an impairment review. The following factors would be considered:

- A career ending injury
- A player who has irrecoverable differences with senior management

The impairment will be based on the directors' best estimate of disposal value taking in to account recent player disposals by the Club and other Clubs, as well as any offers received for the player. When an impairment charge is considered necessary it is charged to the Statement of Comprehensive Income in the period to reduce the carrying value of the player to the player's fair value less any costs to sell.

3.6 Impairment of debtors

The group makes an estimate of the recoverable value of trade and other debtors. When assessing the impairment of trade and other debtors, management considers factors including the current credit rating of the debtor, the ageing of the debtors and historical experience.

3.7 Impairment of tangible assets

The valuation of tangible assets is given consideration by the directors. When a valuation is undertaken, if the value of the assets does not increase, then the impairment of this asset is reflected in the Statement of Comprehensive Income in the year. The basis of valuation of property has changed during the prior year, see note 13 for further details of the revaluation.

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4. Turnover

An analysis of turnover by class of business is as follows:

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Match day	**11,498,190**	*9,656,794*
Broadcasting	**114,330,972**	*42,678,951*
Sponsorship & advertising	**7,261,283**	*5,201,122*
Facility	**4,509,391**	*6,395,521*
	137,599,836	*63,932,388*

Analysis of turnover by country of destination:

	2024 £	*2023 £*
United Kingdom	**133,758,393**	*62,849,208*
Rest of the World	**3,790,708**	*183,640*
Rest of Europe	**50,735**	*899,540*
	137,599,836	*63,932,388*

5. Other operating income

	2024 £	*As restated 2023 £*
Other income	**560,606**	*175,419*

Please see note 30 for information on the restatement of the prior year.

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6. Operating profit/(loss)

The operating profit/(loss) is stated after charging:

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Depreciation of tangible assets	**3,022,233**	*3,499,900*
Amortisation of intangible assets	**20,375,960**	*18,135,763*
Impairment of trade debtors	**184,154**	*183,986*
Impairment of intercompany debtors	**14,378,442**	-
Operating lease rentals	**171,016**	*45,084*
Impairment of tangible assets	**10,701,351**	-

7. Auditor's remuneration

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Fees payable to the company's auditor and its associates for the audit of the company's annual accounts	**90,000**	*75,000*
Fees payable to the company's auditor and its associates in respect of:		
Tax compliance	**37,370**	*28,583*
Other non-audit services	**20,429**	*8,000*
Accounts production	**10,014**	*8,250*
Interim review procedures	**10,000**	*6,180*
Tax advisory	**36,050**	-

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8. Employees

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Wages and salaries	**55,707,251**	*42,460,540*
Social security costs	**7,726,541**	*5,547,481*
Cost of defined contribution scheme	**269,870**	*186,709*
	63,703,662	*48,194,730*

Included in wages and salaries are redundancy and ex-gratia payments of £1,452,550 *(2023: £59,338).*

The directors did not receive any remuneration within the year.

The average monthly number of employees (full time equivalent), including the directors, during the year was as follows:

	2024 No.	*2023* *No.*
Football	**118**	*111*
Non-football	**187**	*184*
	305	*295*

9. Interest receivable and similar income

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Unwinding of discounting on deferred receivables for player registration disposals	**1,550,224**	-

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10. Interest payable and similar expenses

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Other interest payable	**261,688**	*677,623*
Loan interest payable	**5,537,509**	*3,157,659*
Finance leases and hire purchase contracts	**42,380**	*24,393*
Finance costs/(benefit)	**226,045**	*(19,569)*
Unwinding of discounting on deferred payments for player registration disposals	**3,491,137**	-
	9,558,759	*3,840,106*

11. Taxation

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Corporation tax		
Current tax on profits for the year	**2,478,255**	-
Total current tax	**2,478,255**	-
Origination and reversal of timing differences	**(1,000,000)**	-
Total deferred tax	**(1,000,000)**	-
Taxation on profit on ordinary activities	**1,478,255**	-

11. Taxation (continued)

Factors affecting tax charge for the year

The tax assessed for the year is higher than *(2023: higher than)* the standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25% *(2023: 20.5%)*. The differences are explained below:

	2024 £	*As restated 2023 £*
Profit/(loss) on ordinary activities before tax	**3,896,787**	*(31,527,401)*
Profit/(loss) on ordinary activities multiplied by standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25% *(2023: 20.5%)*	**974,197**	*(6,463,117)*
Effects of:		
Other timing differences leading to an increase/(decrease) in taxation	**(282,047)**	*10,311*
Fixed asset differences	**405,812**	*605,628*
Expenses not deductible for tax purposes	**6,171,510**	*925,106*
Non-taxable income	**(119,456)**	*(15,230)*
Adjustments to tax charge in respect of prior periods	**(25,759)**	-
Remeasurement of deferred tax for changes in tax rates	**-**	*(1,084,965)*
Movement in deferred tax not recognised	**(4,618,862)**	*6,022,083*
Group relief surrendered	**(27,140)**	*184*
Recognition of deferred tax asset on prior period tax losses not previously recognised as a deferred tax asset	**(1,000,000)**	-
Total tax charge for the year	**1,478,255**	-

Factors that may affect future tax charges

Unrelieved tax losses of approximately £68,492,153 *(2023: £83,276,441)* remain available to offset against future taxable trading profits.

In the current year a deferred tax asset has been recognised of £1,000,000 (refer to note 3). The total remaining amount unprovided for is approximately £20,001,656 *(2023: £19,564,289)*. At present it is not envisaged that further future taxable profits will be sufficient for these timing differences to be reversed for the remaining amount.

The Finance Act 2021 was substantively enacted in May 2021 and has increased the corporation tax rate from 19% to 25% with effect from 1 April 2023 on profits over £250,000. The rate for small profits under £50,000 will remain at 19%. When the company's profits fall between £50,000 and £250,000, the lower and upper limits, it will be able to claim an amount of marginal relief providing a gradual increase in corporation tax rate. The deferred taxation balances have been measured using the rates expected to apply in the reporting years when the timing differences reverse.

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12. Intangible assets

	Player registrations £	Trademarks £	Total £
Cost			
At 1 July 2023	**86,798,082**	**100,000**	**86,898,082**
Additions	**52,579,586**	**-**	**52,579,586**
Disposals	**(21,926,959)**	**-**	**(21,926,959)**
At 30 June 2024	**117,450,709**	**100,000**	**117,550,709**
Amortisation			
At 1 July 2023	**68,235,013**	**100,000**	**68,335,013**
Charge for the year	**20,375,960**	**-**	**20,375,960**
Disposals	**(17,515,401)**	**-**	**(17,515,401)**
At 30 June 2024	**71,095,572**	**100,000**	**71,195,572**
Net book value			
At 30 June 2024	**46,355,137**	**-**	**46,355,137**
At 30 June 2023	*18,563,069*	-	*18,563,069*

The intangible asset that is material to the financial statements is the first team squad. The carrying value of the squad has a remaining amortisation period of 1-3 years.

Amortisation on intangible assets is charged to administrative expenses.

The figures for cost of player registrations are historic figures for the cost associated with acquiring players' registrations or extending their contracts. Accordingly the net book amount of player registrations will not reflect, nor is it intended to, the current market value of these players nor does it take any account of players developed through the company's youth system.

The directors consider the net realisable value of intangible assets to be significantly greater than their book value.

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13. Tangible assets

	Land and buildings £	Fixtures and fittings £	Motor vehicles £	Total £
Cost/Valuation				
At 1 July 2023	**54,343,501**	**15,422,001**	**22,665**	**69,788,167**
Additions	**7,205,587**	**4,981,441**	**-**	**12,187,028**
At 30 June 2024	**61,549,088**	**20,403,442**	**22,665**	**81,975,195**
Depreciation				
At 1 July 2023	**4,166,004**	**11,474,178**	**22,665**	**15,662,847**
Charge for the year	**1,062,730**	**1,959,503**	**-**	**3,022,233**
Impairment charge	**20,725,888**	**-**	**-**	**20,725,888**
At 30 June 2024	**25,954,622**	**13,433,681**	**22,665**	**39,410,968**
Net book value				
At 30 June 2024	**35,594,466**	**6,969,761**	**-**	**42,564,227**
At 30 June 2023	*50,177,497*	*3,947,823*	*-*	*54,125,320*

The net carrying amount of assets held under hire purchase agreements is £262,426 *(2023: £503,253)*. These assets are all included within fixtures and fittings.

The properties held by the company have been revalued as at 25 July 2024 following an independent valuation. The basis of valuation has been undertaken as the market value in accordance with the RICS valuation - professional standards, 'The estimated amount for which an asset or liability should exchange on the valuation date between a willing buyer and a willing seller in an arm's length transaction after proper marketing and where the parties had each acted knowledgeably, prudently and without compulsion'. Prior to the revaluations, the carrying amount that would have been recognised under the cost model was £40,709,534 *(2023: £42,435,096)*.

An impairment of charge of £20,725,887 has been made to the properties held by The Sheffield United Football Club Limited, with £10,024,537 being eliminated from the revaluation reserve and the balance of £10,701,351 being charged through profit and loss.

Prior to the revaluations in 2022 and 2024, the carrying amount that would have been recognised under the cost model was £40,709,534 *(2023: £42,435,096)*.

Land valued at £1,376,352, is not subject to depreciation within the land and buildings category.

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14. Fixed asset investments

	Investments in subsidiary companies £
Cost or valuation	
Additions	2
At 30 June 2024	2
Net book value	
At 30 June 2024	2
At 30 June 2023	-

Subsidiary undertakings

The following were subsidiary undertakings of the company:

Name	Registered office	Class of shares	Holding
SUFC Women Limited	Professional football club	Ordinary	100%
SUFC Hotel Ltd	Hotel	Ordinary	100%
SUFC Crookes Ltd	Dormant	Ordinary	100%
SUFC Bramall Lane Ltd	Dormant	Ordinary	100%
SUFC Enterprise Centre Ltd	Dormant	Ordinary	100%
SUFC Shirecliffe Ltd	Dormant	Ordinary	100%

All subsidiary undertakings are registered at Bramall Lane Ground, Cherry Street, S2 4SU and are incorporated in England and Wales.

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15. Stocks

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Goods for resale	**442,514**	*414,789*

Stock is stated after provision for impairment of £33,731 *(2023: £15,099)*.

Stock recognised as an expense during the year was £1,690,668 *(2023: £1,365,326)*.

16. Debtors

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Due after more than one year		
Trade debtors	**11,748,583**	-

Included within trade debtors are amounts totalling £11,748,583 *(2023: £Nil)* relating to the consideration receivable for the sale of player registrations.

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Due within one year		
Trade debtors	**8,822,638**	*11,974,000*
Amounts owed by group	**125,924**	*14,781,710*
Other debtors	**1,852,162**	*499,673*
Prepayments and accrued income	**851,041**	*1,322,641*
Corporation tax recoverable	**1,048,162**	*706,149*
Deferred taxation	**1,000,000**	-
	13,699,927	*29,284,173*

Included within trade debtors are amounts totalling £6,758,947 *(2023: £8,412,760)* relating to the consideration receivable for the sale of player registrations.

Trade debtors stated after provision of £330,253 *(2023: £356,704)*.

Amounts owed by group undertakings are repayable on demand.

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17. Cash and cash equivalents

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Cash at bank and in hand	**376,906**	*630,061*

18. Creditors: Amounts falling due within one year

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Bank loans (note 20)	**9,045,242**	-
Factored loans (note 20)	**4,940,527**	*7,788,840*
Trade creditors	**22,439,562**	*9,390,875*
Football league pension liability	**137,296**	*130,758*
Amounts owed to group	**76,483**	*512,058*
Other taxation and social security	**3,193,207**	*1,390,784*
Net obligations under finance lease and hire purchase contracts (note 21)	**67,985**	*73,018*
Other creditors	**1,317,283**	*1,141,326*
Accruals	**4,571,113**	*17,107,481*
	45,788,698	*37,535,140*

Included within trade creditors and accruals are amounts totalling £19,504,081 *(2023: £5,651,724)* relating to the consideration payable for the purchase of player registrations.

Amounts owed to group are repayable on demand.

The finance leases and hire purchase contracts are secured on the assets to which they relate.

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19. Creditors: Amounts falling due after more than one year

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Bank loans (note 20)	**23,954,758**	*45,000,000*
Factored loans (note 20)	**13,031,298**	-
Net obligations under finance leases and hire purchase contracts (note 21)	**220,338**	*288,323*
Trade creditors	**20,299,283**	*833,133*
Football league pension liability	**455,148**	*366,403*
Preference share capital treated as debt (note 24)	**9,130**	*9,130*
	57,969,955	*46,496,989*

Included within trade creditors are amounts totalling £20,299,283 (2023: £833,133) relating to the consideration payable for the purchase of player registrations.

Disclosure of the terms and conditions attached to the non-equity shares is made in note 24.

The finance leases and hire purchase contracts are secured on the assets to which they relate.

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20. Loans

Analysis of the maturity of loans is given below:

	2024 £	*2023* *£*
Bank loans		
Amounts falling due within one year	**9,045,242**	-
Amounts falling due 1-2 years	**23,954,758**	*45,000,000*
	33,000,000	*45,000,000*
Factored loans		
Amounts falling due within one year	**4,940,527**	*7,788,840*
Amounts falling due 1-5 years	**13,031,298**	-
	17,971,825	*7,788,840*

The bank loan is secured by way of fixed and floating charges over the assets and properties of The Sheffield United Football Club Limited and fixed charges over the Central Funds from the Premier League. The principal element of the loan is due for final repayment by the company in May 2026, with interest and principal payments being required in instalments.

As at 30 June 2023, the Clubs payment terms on the facilities fell greater than one year, assuming Premier League retention as the repayment terms of banking facilities are dependent upon football league status, with £5,298,562 being due within the year if the Club were relegated at the conclusion on the 2023/24 season. Subsequent to the prior year end, an amendment had been made on the banking facility whereby £2,250,000 fell due within 12 months.

Charges registered for The Sheffield United Football Club Limited for bank loans:
0006 1564 0038 - 28 June 2024, in favour of Macquarie Bank Limited, London Branch
0006 1564 0039 - 28 June 2024, in favour of Macquarie Bank Limited, London Branch

Charges registered for The Sheffield United Football Club Limited for factored loans:
0006 1564 0032 - 4 January 2023, in favour of Close Leasing Limited
0006 1564 0037 - 29 May 2024, in favour of Macquarie Bank Limited, London Branch

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21. Hire purchase and finance leases

Minimum lease payments under hire purchase fall due as follows:

	2024 £	*2023 £*
Within one year	**98,172**	*114,998*
Between 1-5 years	**254,053**	*352,225*
	352,225	*467,223*
Less interest	**(63,901)**	*(105,881)*
	288,324	*361,342*

22. Deferred income

	2024 £	*As restated 2023 £*
Sponsorship	**2,618,033**	*2,660,260*
Advance ticket sales	**5,529,733**	*5,393,142*
Broadcasting	**-**	*45,000*
	8,147,766	*8,098,402*

Please see note 30 for information on the restatement of prior year.

23. Deferred taxation

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are offset where the company has a legally enforceable right to do so. The following is the analysis of the deferred tax balances (after offset) for financial reporting purposes:

	2024 £
Credit to Statement of Comprehensive Income	**1,000,000**
At end of year	**1,000,000**

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23. Deferred taxation (continued)

The deferred tax asset is made up as follows:

	2024	*2023*
	£	*£*
Tax losses	**1,000,000**	*-*

The deferred tax asset set out above is expected to reverse within 12 months and relates principally to the utilisation of tax losses against future expected profits of the same period.

24. Share capital

	2024	*2023*
	£	*£*
Shares classified as equity		
Allotted, called up and fully paid		
477 Deferred shares of £100 each	**47,700**	*47,700*
144,801 Ordinary shares of £500 each	**72,400,500**	*72,400,500*
204 Deferred shares of £0.01 each	**2**	*2*
	72,448,202	*72,448,202*

There is a single class of ordinary shares. There are no restrictions on dividends and the repayment of capital.

There are two classes of deferred shares. There are restrictions on dividends and the repayment of capital.

	2024	*2023*
	£	*£*
Shares classified as debt		
913 Preference shares of £10 each	**9,130**	*9,130*

There is a single class of preference shares. There are restrictions on dividends and the repayment of capital.

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25. Reserves

Revaluation reserve

Includes reserves for the revaluation of tangible asset buildings.

Profit & loss account

Includes all current and prior period retained profits and losses.

26. Pension commitments

Sheffield United Football Club ('the Club') participates in the Football League Pension and Life Assurance Scheme ('the Scheme'). The Scheme is a funded multi-employer defined benefit scheme, with 92 participating employers, and where members may have periods of service attributable to several participating employers. The Club is unable to identify its share of the assets and liabilities of the Scheme and therefore accounts for its contributions as if they were paid to a defined contribution scheme.

The last actuarial valuation was carried out at 31 August 2023 where the total deficit on the on-going valuation basis was £20.6 million. The key assumptions used to calculate the deficit at the 31 August 2020 actuarial valuation are:

Discount Rate:	Gilt Yield Curve + 0.5% per annum
RPI inflation:	Bank of England Inflation Curve
Pension Increases:	Fixed 3.0% per annum for benefits accrued prior to 6 April 1997, and modelled using the RPI inflation assumption with a cap of 5.0% per annum and a floor of 3.0% per annum for benefits accrued after 6 April 1997.
Mortality (pre-retirement):	None
Mortality (post-retirement):	SAPS (Series 3) with CMI_2022 projections, a long-term improvement rate of 1.5% p.a. and an initial additional parameter of 0.5% p.a.

The accrual of benefits ceased within the Scheme on 31 August 1999, therefore there are no contributions relating to current accrual. The Club pays monthly contributions based on a notional split of the total expenses and deficit contributions of the Scheme.

The results of the 2023 valuation were rolled forward to 30 June 2024 on the same assumptions as detailed above, and the Club's notional share of the deficit was £509,576 *(£484,123 as at 30 June 2023)*.

As at 30 June 2024, the Club was paying total contributions of £10,984 per month (increasing by 5% p.a. on 1 September each year) and based on the actuarial valuation assumptions detailed above will be sufficient to pay off the deficit by 30 November 2028.

As at 30 June 2024, based on an appropriate discount rate of 4.96% per annum *(6.39% per annum as at 30 June 2023)*, the present value of the Club's outstanding contributions (i.e. their future liability) is £592,444 *(£497,161 as at 30 June 2023)*. This amounts to £137,296 *(30 June 2023: £130,758)* due within one year and £455,148 *(30 June 2023: £366,403)* due after more than one year and is included within other payables.

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26. Pension commitments (continued)

Present Value of Defined Benefit Obligation

	2024 £	2023 £
Present Value of Defined Benefit Obligation	**592,444**	*497,161*

Reconciliation of Defined Benefit Obligation

	2024 £	2023 £
Defined benefit obligation at start of period	**497,161**	*641,267*
Net interest charge (unwinding of discount rate)	**27,612**	*15,637*
Club contribution (deficit contribution)	**(130,758)**	*(124,537)*
Remeasurement (changes in assumptions)	**8,133**	*(35,206)*
Remeasurement (change to contribution schedule)	**190,296**	-
Defined benefit obligation at end of period	**592,444**	*497,161*

Income and expenditure impact

	2024 £	2023 £
Net interest charge (unwinding of discount rate)	**27,612**	*15,637*
Remeasurement (changes in assumptions)	**8,133**	*(35,206)*
Remeasurement (change to contribution schedule)	**190,296**	-

Assumptions

	2024	2023
Discount rate	**4.96%**	*6.39%*

The funding objective of the Trustees of the Scheme is to have sufficient assets to meet the Technical Provisions of the Scheme. In order to remove the deficit revealed at the previous actuarial valuation (dated 31 August 2023), deficit contributions are payable by all participating clubs. Payments are made in accordance with a pension contribution schedule. As the Scheme is closed to accrual, there are no additional costs associated with the accruing of members' future benefits. In the case of a club being relegated from the Football League and being unable to settle its debt then the remaining clubs may, in exceptional circumstances, have to share the deficit.

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26. Pension commitments (continued)

Upon the wind-up of the Scheme with a surplus, any surplus will be used to augment benefits. Under the more likely scenario of there being a deficit, this will be split amongst the clubs in line with their contribution schedule. Should an individual club leave the Scheme, they may be required to pay their share of the deficit based on a proxy buyout basis (i.e. valuing the benefits on a basis consistent with buying out the benefits with an insurance company).

A financial cost of £226,045 *(2023: financial benefit of £19,569)* is made to the Statement of Comprehensive Income during the year, representing the interest costs on the outstanding deficit of the scheme.

In addition, the company operates a defined contributions pension scheme. The assets of the scheme are held separately from those of the group in an independently administered fund. The pension cost charge represents contributions payable by the company to the fund and amounted to £269,870 *(2023: £186,709)*. Contributions totalling £34,836 *(2023: £42,830)* were payable to the fund at the reporting date.

27. Capital commitments

As at 30 June 2024, The Sheffield United Football Club had paid a 10% deposit for the purchase of the HSBC Sports and Social Club site in Dore with the sale completing and the remaining balance of £2.7 million to due to be paid in August 2024.

The refurbishment of SUFC Hotel Ltd was well underway as at 30 June 2024, with a remaining committed spend of £1.7 million to ensure the opening of the Hotel in August 2024.

28. Commitments under operating leases

At 30 June 2024 the company had future minimum lease payments due under non-cancellable operating leases for each of the following periods:

	2024	*2023*
	£	*£*
Not later than 1 year	**119,291**	*68,233*
Later than 1 year and not later than 5 years	**129,751**	*108,748*
	249,042	*176,981*

A pass through lease has been established between SUFC Women Limited and The Sheffield United Football Club Limited, whereby the lease income and expenditure for each company are equal and opposite, and therefore in the year 1 July 2023 to 30 June 2024 offset one another in the accounts. The lease expires in September 2038.

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29. Related party transactions

As a wholly owned subsidiary of Blades Leisure Limited, the company is exempt from the requirements of FRS 102 to disclose transactions with other members of the group headed by Blades Leisure Limited on the grounds that accounts are publicly available.

Purchases were credited of £16 *(2023: made £618)* from KFCO Beerschot-Wilrijk NV with a period end creditor balance of £Nil *(2023: £618)*.

Purchases were made of £389,787 *(2023: £847,774)* from United World Holding Limited with a period end creditor balance of £389,787 *(2023: £847,774)*. Sales were made of £1,209,462 *(2023: £902,273)* to United World SA with a period end debtor balance of £394,369 *(2023: £1,335,138)*. Purchases were made of £1,580,119 and consultancy fees were charged of £3,006,000 *(2023: purchases £975,698 and consultancy fees £3,825,462)* from United World SA with a period end creditor balance of £90 *(2023: £2,735,905)*. The consultancy fees to United World SA certain costs including staff related costs which are borne by another group company. The directors did not receive any remuneration from the company in respect of their services during the year. Certain directors who served during the year are also directors of the parent company or a fellow subsidiary company and are remunerated by those companies. Although they receive remuneration in respect of their services to various group companies, including this company, it is not practicable to allocate their remuneration to individual companies in the group. Therefore, their remuneration has been disclosed in the financial statements of the relevant company from which remuneration is received.

Sales were made of £175,190 *(2023: £107,937)* to Sheffield United Community Foundation with a period end debtor balance of £51,473 *(2023: £15,865)*. Purchases were made of £9,706 *(2023: £Nil)* from Sheffield United Community Foundation with a period end creditor balance of £92 *(2023: £Nil)*.

During the year, the company received a loan of £Nil *(2023: £22,720,886)* from the ultimate parent company, United World Holding Limited. No interest is payable other than in the event of default.

30. Prior year adjustment

The directors have reviewed the documentation related to the deferred capital grants and determined that a prior year adjustment is required. This adjustment arises from the fact that the grants were linked to properties previously sold and subsequently repurchased, meaning no clawback obligation exists on the original grant. As a result, the adjustment has impacted the reserves position by £1,884,941 with a restatement to deferred income amounting to £1,884,941 and other operating income amounting to £74,308 in the prior year.

	As restated 2023	2023
The Sheffield United Football Club Limited	**£**	**£**
Deferred income - Deferred capital grant	-	(1,884,941)
Other operating income - Other grants released	-	74,308
Capital and reserves - Profit and loss account	(71,585,857)	(73,470,798)

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31. Post balance sheet events

After the year end, the Club made several changes to its first team squad. A successful summer 2024 transfer market resulted in a profit on disposal of player registrations of £22.3 million, following the sale of Daniel Jebbison to AFC Bournemouth, Cameron Archer, back to Aston Villa, William Osula to Newcastle United, Levis Pitan to Gliwicki Klub Sportoway Piast SA, Bénie Traoré to FC Basel 1893 AG, Jayden Bogle to Leeds United and Auston Trusty to Celtic. Harrison Burrows from Peterborough United, Michael Cooper from Plymouth Argyle and Keiffer Moore from AFC Bournemouth were recruited in place of these players, at a total acquisition cost of £6.9 million.

An administrative exercise was undertaken in July 2024 in order to redeem a class of shares for which the rights had expired. All 204 holders of the £0.01 deferred share and all 477 holder of the £100 deferred shares were advised in writing that on the 31 July 2024 the Club would be redeeming each of these shares for the price of £1 per share. These shares were redeemed in full, in accordance with the Articles of Association on the 31st July 2024.

On 23 August 2024, The DoubleTree by Hilton Sheffield City hotel opened became operational following a full redevelopment and refurbishment. The hotel will be operated by leaf HOSPITALITY, the UK based Hotel Management company, who manage a number of Hilton properties across the UK, and under a Franchise Agreement with Hilton Worldwide Holdings Inc.

On 29 August 2024, the sale of the Hathersage Road site (previously HSBC Sports Ground) was completed. The addition of the site offers the Club the opportunity to create a state-of-the-art training facility that will allow the Club the opportunity to expand both its First Team, and Academy operations.

On 23 December 2024, a change of control occurred in respect of the Blades Leisure Group, the parent of The Sheffield United Football Club Limited. COH Bidco Limited, a company registered in England in 2024, acquired 100% of the share capital in Blades Leisure Limited. The ultimate parent company of the Blades Leisure Group is now COH Sports United LLC, a company registered in Delaware, United States of America. This entity is jointly controlled by the trusts of Steven Harlan Rosen and Helmy Atef Eltoukhy.

32. Contingent transfer fees payable

Under the terms of certain contracts with other football clubs in respect of player transfers, certain additional amounts would be payable by the company if conditions as to future team selection or performance are met. The maximum that could be payable is £11,553,813 *(2023: £11,686,355)*. This amount is not provided in the financial statements as payment is not yet probable.

33. Liability limitation agreement with the auditor

The company has entered into a liability limitation agreement with Grant Thornton UK LLP, the statutory auditors, in respect of the statutory audit for the year ended 30 June 2024. The proportionate liability agreement follows the standard terms in Appendix B to the Financial Reporting Council's June 2008 Guidance on Auditors Liability Agreements, and was approved by the shareholders on 31 July 2024.

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34. Ultimate parent and controlling party

The directors consider that the immediate parent of this company is Blades Leisure Limited located at Bramall Lane, Cherry Street, Sheffield, Yorkshire, S2 45U, a company incorporated in England and Wales by virtue of its 100% shareholding. For the period covered in the financial statements, Blades Leisure Limited is a wholly owned subsidiary of United World Holding Limited located at Elizabeth House, Les Ruettes Brayes, St Peter Port, Guernsey, GY1 1EW, a Guernsey registered company.

HRH Prince Abdullah Bin Mossad Bin Abdulaziz Al Saud is the ultimate beneficiary of the Blades Leisure Limited group of companies.